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Doctor-visit checklist for HRT

Bring this to your next appointment about perimenopause, menopause or HRT.

Bring with you

- Your current HRT: which form (patch, gel, spray, tablet, vaginal), product name, and when you started
- Notes from the last few weeks: hot flashes and night sweats, sleep, mood, and anything new
- Dates of any bleeding or spotting
- Any side effects, and when they began
- Your history of blood clots, stroke or breast cancer, including in close family
- When your last mammogram was

Questions you could ask

- Are my symptoms improving as expected?
- Is my bleeding pattern expected for my type of HRT?
- Would a different form of HRT (patch, gel, spray or tablet) suit me better?
- Do I have risk factors that affect which HRT is right for me?
- Do I still need contraception?
- Could vaginal estrogen help with vaginal symptoms?
- When should we review my treatment again?

Contact your doctor sooner if

- You have any vaginal bleeding after 12 months or more without a period
- Irregular bleeding continues more than 6 months after starting HRT, or bleeding gets heavier
- Side effects are severe, or last longer than 3 months

Sources

- NHS: www.nhs.uk/medicines/hormone-replacement-therapy-hrt/side-effects-of-h
- NHS: www.nhs.uk/conditions/menopause/symptoms/
- NHS: www.nhs.uk/medicines/hormone-replacement-therapy-hrt/benefits-and-risk
- NHS: www.nhs.uk/medicines/hormone-replacement-therapy-hrt/types-of-hormone-
- NICE (UK) NG23, Menopause: identification and management: www.nice.org.uk/guidance/ng23/chapter/Recommendations

General information, not medical advice.